

Katrina Engelsted

Boulder, Colorado, USA

katrina@engelsted.co
774.239.8699
linkedin.com/in/katrinae

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The Wilderness Society Hiring Team

The Wilderness Society

RE: DATA AND ANALYTICS DIRECTOR (1-YEAR TERM)

Dear Hiring Team,

I'm applying for this role because I want the next chapter of my work to matter in a specific way. We're living through a moment when the political will to act on climate feels shakier than it has in years, even as the UN keeps reminding us how little room is left before 1.5°C of warming becomes locked in — and how unevenly that cost will land, on wildlife that has no say in the matter and on a generation that's currently too young to vote on it. **I don't want to spend more of my career optimizing funnels for products that don't need saving. I want to point the same skills at something that does.** The Wilderness Society, protecting the places that make that fight winnable since 1935, is exactly that something.

My background happens to sit right at the intersection this role needs. I've owned marketing-technology stacks end-to-end — the Salesforce CRM and marketing-automation platform at Zayo, persona-driven campaign infrastructure at Teren — and I hold a BA in Geography (GIS), with Honors, and a spatial-statistics thesis, on top of three years building GIS mapping tools for the National Park Service. I've worked inside an enterprise customer data platform at Lytics, and built a Snowflake-based data warehouse and pipeline for a utility-sector capstone project. Most recently, I've been building and governing production AI-agent workflows as a startup advisor, and independently building a semantic layer on top of dbt — the same "documented, governed reporting layer" this role is asking someone to build for TWS.

I'll be straightforward about where I don't check every box: my data-and-CRM-titled experience is closer to five or six years than the eight the posting asks for, and while I've hired, managed, and trained a technical team, I haven't done it at director scale. What I'd bring instead is real hands-on depth in the exact combination this role needs — CRM and marketing-technology systems, data warehousing, applied AI in production, and a GIS background that very few data-and-analytics candidates will have — plus the judgment to know when a shortcut is actually a risk.

I care about this work beyond the job description. I want to be able to tell my kid, someday, that when it mattered, I used what I know how to build for something other than another company's growth chart. I'd welcome the chance to talk through how that shows up in the data warehouse, the CRM, and the AI tooling this role is responsible for.

Thank you for considering my application.

Warmly,

Katrina Engelsted

BOULDER, COLORADO